

# Tuesday, 4 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

## 00 — WEATHER

### Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

**28°** 20°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

**26°** 19°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

**25°** 18°

GLASGOW

Showers

**20°** 15°

## 01 — NEWS

### Today's top stories

1

**The English Football Association is reportedly set to withdraw its support for current Fifa president Gianni Infantino.**

This follows similar action from Wales and comes amid the fallout from Infantino's controversial plans to sell off stakes in Fifa competitions to private investors. It marks a significant move against the football chief.

FOOTBALL · UK

2

**A grooming gang has been found guilty of exploiting and sexually abusing teenage girls after a three-month trial.**

The court heard harrowing details of how the young victims were given drugs and subjected to sexual abuse. This verdict brings some justice for the girls involved.

CRIME · UK

3

**A man has been arrested in connection with the death of a nine-year-old girl found injured on an industrial estate.**

The young girl, from West Yorkshire, was discovered in Arbroath shortly after midnight. Police are continuing their investigation into the tragic incident.

CRIME · UK

4

**Almost £200,000 worth of fuel is being stolen from UK forecourts every single day, new analysis reveals.**

Incidents of drivers taking fuel without payment have risen by a fifth in just five months since the Iran war began. It's a significant cost for businesses and ultimately, consumers.

CRIME · UK

5

**France has strongly criticised Reform UK's proposal to use the Navy to return migrants to France.**

The party stated it would override French objections to implement the plan. This has sparked a diplomatic row between the two nations.

POLITICS · UK

## What's coming up

### 1 **The new Spider-Man film has swung into cinemas, achieving the second-biggest global opening weekend ever!**

This fantastic box office performance is a huge boost for Disney. It sets the stage perfectly for the eagerly awaited release of 'Avengers: Doomsday'.

**ON AIR** – Are you a big fan of the Spider-Man films? What makes them so popular?

FILM · COMING UP

### 2 **Spider-Man fans are hailing Tom Holland's latest web-slinging adventure, 'Brand New Day', as his best performance yet!**

The film has clearly resonated with audiences, with many praising Holland's portrayal of the iconic superhero. It seems he's truly made the role his own.

**ON AIR** – Have you seen the new Spider-Man film? What did you think of it?

FILM · COMING UP

### 3 **Sam Fender and Olivia Dean have made chart history with their duet 'Rein Me In', breaking a 73-year-old record!**

The track has now spent an incredible 19 non-consecutive weeks at the top of the UK singles chart. It's a testament to its enduring popularity and their combined talent.

**ON AIR** – What's a song that you just can't stop listening to at the moment?

MUSIC · WHEN

### 4 **A union is urging the makers of the highly anticipated video game 'GTA 6', Rockstar, to address working conditions.**

They're calling for better working conditions and pay transparency ahead of the game's release. It's a big conversation around the gaming industry right now.

**ON AIR** – Are you excited for the new GTA 6? Do you think game developers face a lot of pressure?

GAMING · COMING UP

### 5 **Fans of dating shows are increasingly turning to the US version of 'Love Island', saying the contestants 'actually fancy each other'!**

Commentators and even a former Islander are reflecting on what the UK series could do to attract more viewers. It seems authenticity is key for audiences.

**ON AIR** – Are you a fan of 'Love Island'? Do you think the US version is better?

TV · WHEN

## On the schedule

- 1** **England midfielder Jordan Henderson has officially joined Chelsea after his contract with Brentford was mutually terminated.**

The free agent has signed a two-year deal with the London club. It's a big move for the experienced player ahead of the new season.

**ON AIR** – Chelsea fans, are you happy to see Jordan Henderson join? What do you think he'll bring to the team?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2** **Celtic have been drawn against Austrian champions LASK in the Champions League play-off round.**

Meanwhile, four other Scottish sides have discovered their potential opponents in the Europa League and Conference League. It's a crucial time for Scottish clubs in European competition.

**ON AIR** – Celtic fans, how do you feel about facing LASK in the Champions League play-offs?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3** **Britain's Mimi Rhodes and Ireland's Leona Maguire have earned wildcard picks for Europe's Solheim Cup team!**

They'll be taking on the United States in the prestigious golf tournament next month in the Netherlands. It's a huge honour for both players.

**ON AIR** – Are you excited for the Solheim Cup? Do you think Europe has a strong chance this year?

GOLF · UK
- 4** **Newly crowned five-time Tour de France champion Tadej Pogacar will be riding in this month's Vuelta a Espana.**

He's attempting to win all three of cycling's Grand Tours in one season, which would be an incredible achievement. All eyes will be on him.

**ON AIR** – Do you follow competitive cycling? Could Pogacar achieve the Grand Tour treble?

CYCLING · UK
- 5** **Japan's Shiho Kuwaki has lifted the Women's Open title, winning a tense two-hole play-off against Esther Henseleit!**

It marks Kuwaki's first major title in a thrilling finish to the tournament. What a fantastic achievement for her!

**ON AIR** – Did you watch the Women's Open? What did you think of the dramatic finish?

GOLF · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that 'daydreaming' might actually boost our creativity and problem-solving skills.**  
Researchers found that allowing your mind to wander can help connect seemingly unrelated ideas, leading to fresh perspectives. So, next time you're caught staring out the window, tell them you're just being innovative!
- 2 The trend of 'swapping clothes with friends' is gaining popularity as a fun and sustainable way to refresh your wardrobe.**  
It's a fantastic way to discover new styles without spending a penny, and it's much better for the planet than fast fashion. Plus, it's a lovely excuse for a good natter!
- 3 More people are discovering the simple joy of 'sketching in public parks' to relax and unwind.**  
Armed with a notepad and pencil, they're capturing the beauty of nature and everyday life. It's a wonderful, mindful activity that costs next to nothing.
- 4 Experts are highlighting how 'listening to podcasts' can be a great way to learn new things and broaden your horizons during daily commutes.**  
Whether it's history, true crime, or comedy, there's a podcast for every interest. It turns travel time into learning time, or just a good giggle.
- 5 There's a growing appreciation for 'traditional British puddings', with a resurgence in home baking.**  
Think treacle tart, spotted dick, and crumble – these comforting classics are making a comeback in kitchens across the country. Perfect for a chilly evening.
- 6 The unexpected pleasure of 'spotting vintage cars' on the road is bringing a smile to many motorists.**  
Catching a glimpse of a beautifully preserved classic car can transport you back in time and add a touch of nostalgia to your journey. Always a talking point!
- 7 A new appreciation for the 'calming effect of watching clouds' is emerging as a simple stress-buster.**  
Taking a few moments to simply observe the ever-changing shapes in the sky can be surprisingly meditative. It's a free and natural way to relax.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

### OUR SURVEY SAID

**Q** Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our shopping list, even if we've typed it out on our phone?

**ANSWER:** REWRITING IT BY HAND ON A SCRAP OF PAPER, JUST FOR GOOD MEASURE!

**Q** Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh slice of toast. What is it?

**ANSWER:** CAREFULLY SPREADING THE BUTTER RIGHT TO THE VERY EDGES, WITHOUT MISSING A SPOT!

### TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem' in your local area, something you've walked past hundreds of times but never truly noticed?**

What's a local hidden gem you've recently stumbled upon, perhaps a quirky shop, a beautiful park bench, or a charming little café, and what makes it so special to you?

- **We all have those 'unwritten rules' in our family or household that everyone just implicitly understands, even if they've never been officially stated.**

What's an amusing or endearing 'unwritten rule' that operates in your home, perhaps about who gets the last biscuit, or how the TV remote is always returned?

### TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **Animals.** A group of pugs is called a 'grumble'.

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which are covered in tiny chemoreceptors.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£6.8 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£6.8 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- The inventor of the frisbee was cremated and his ashes were moulded into frisbees.
- Bananaphobia is the fear of bananas.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, reported in Montana in 1887.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the known universe.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- A 'supercentenarian' is a person who has reached the age of 110 years or more.

## On this day

Day 216 of the year, 149 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aristarchus; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecilia Cesarini; Christian feast day: Euphronius; Christian feast day: Blessed Frédéric Janssoone. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Robbin Crosby, American guitarist and songwriter (died 2002)
- 1957 — John Wark, Scottish footballer and sportscaster
- 1992 — Cole Sprouse, American actor
- 1968 — Lee Mack, English comedian, actor, producer, and screenwriter
- 1940 — Timi Yuro, American singer-songwriter (died 2004)
- 1970 — John August, American director and screenwriter
- 1941 — Cliff Nobles, American musician (died 2008)
- 1992 — Dylan Sprouse, American actor

### THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — A massacre is carried out by Sri Lankan government forces, killing 17 employees of the French INGO Action Against Hunger (known internationally as Action Contre la Faim, or ACF).
- 1995 — Operation Storm, the last major battle of the Croatian War of Independence begins.
- 2020 — Beirut Port explosion: At least 220 people are killed and over 5,000 are wounded when 2,700 tons of ammonium nitrate explodes in Beirut, Lebanon.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1984 — The Ariane 3 rocket is launched for the first time, carrying the Eutelsat I F-2 and Télécom 1A satellites into geosynchronous transfer orbit.
- 2007 — NASA's Phoenix Mars lander is launched.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1924 — Diplomatic relations between Mexico and the Soviet Union are established.
- 1965 — The Constitution of the Cook Islands comes into force, giving the Cook Islands self-governing status within New Zealand.

- 1977 — U.S. President Jimmy Carter signs legislation creating the United States Department of Energy.



## A peek at tomorrow

Day 217 of the year, 148 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abel of Reims; Christian feast day: Addai; Christian feast day: Afra; Christian feast day: Cassian of Autun. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Michael Walsh, English footballer
- 1979 — David Healy, Irish footballer
- 2008 — Hudson Meek, American actor (died 2024)
- 1946 — Erika Slezak, American actress
- 1980 — Jesse Williams, American actor, director, producer, and political activist
- 1956 — Maureen McCormick, American actress
- 1943 — Sammi Smith, American country music singer-songwriter (died 2005)
- 1965 — Jeff Coffin, American saxophonist and composer

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1963 — Cold War: The United States, the United Kingdom, and the Soviet Union sign the Partial Nuclear Test Ban Treaty.
- 2010 — The Copiapó mining accident occurs, trapping 33 Chilean miners approximately 2,300 ft (700 m) below the ground for 69 days.
- 1984 — A Biman Bangladesh Airlines Fokker F27 Friendship crashes on approach to Zia International Airport, in Dhaka, Bangladesh, killing all 49 people on board.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1957 — American Bandstand, a show dedicated to the teenage "baby-boomers" by playing the songs and showing popular dances of the time, debuts on the ABC television network.
- 2024 — Following the non-cooperation movement against the government of Bangladesh, Bangladeshi prime minister Sheikh Hasina resigns and flees the country, ending her rule of 15 consecutive years and a total of almost two decades. The date is also known as 36 July.

## Coming to cinemas

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### AUGUST 2026

|        |                                                 |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------|
| FRI 7  | Once Upon a Time in a Cinema                    |
| FRI 14 | Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie |
| FRI 21 | Mutiny; The Bride!                              |
| FRI 28 | Crime 101; Outcome                              |

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### SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

|        |                       |
|--------|-----------------------|
| FRI 4  | Conjuring: Last Rites |
| FRI 11 | Resident Evil reboot  |
| FRI 18 | The Black Phone 2     |
| FRI 25 | Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)   |

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### OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

|        |                                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------|
| FRI 16 | Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller |
| FRI 23 | Frankenstein (del Toro)                 |

## On the sporting calendar

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### AUGUST 2026

|        |                                        |
|--------|----------------------------------------|
| W/C 10 | Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)   |
| SAT 15 | Premier League season begins (2026/27) |
| 22–23  | Belgian Grand Prix (F1)                |